SALES DEVELOPMENT

MODELS, METRICS, AND COMPENSATION RESEARCH

The Bridge Group

INTRODUCTION

Hello! And welcome to the tenth round of biennial research focused on Sales Development.

Since 2007, we've been tracking the SDR (ADRs, BDRs, xDRs, etc.) role with a focus on how metrics and compensation change over time. For this round, **351 B2B companies** participated. We've organized the report into five sections:

1. Organizational Structure
2. Ramp & Retention
3. Metrics & Quota
4. Compensation & Tech
5. Leadership

We hope this report will provide guidance as you build out your strategy or think about changes to possibly bring you closer to alignment with industry standards.

If you have any questions, please reach out to us directly. We want to hear from you. You can email us at: community@bridgegroupinc.com.

We help b2b tech companies build, scale, or optimize their proactive sales efforts. We think about impact in days and weeks because our clients can't wait quarters to see results.

We’re an SDR, AE, and AM consulting firm dedicated to understanding the *models*, *metrics*, and *motions* that deliver scalable growth.

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Breaking down the 2025 SDR report
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0kavMnPTchM

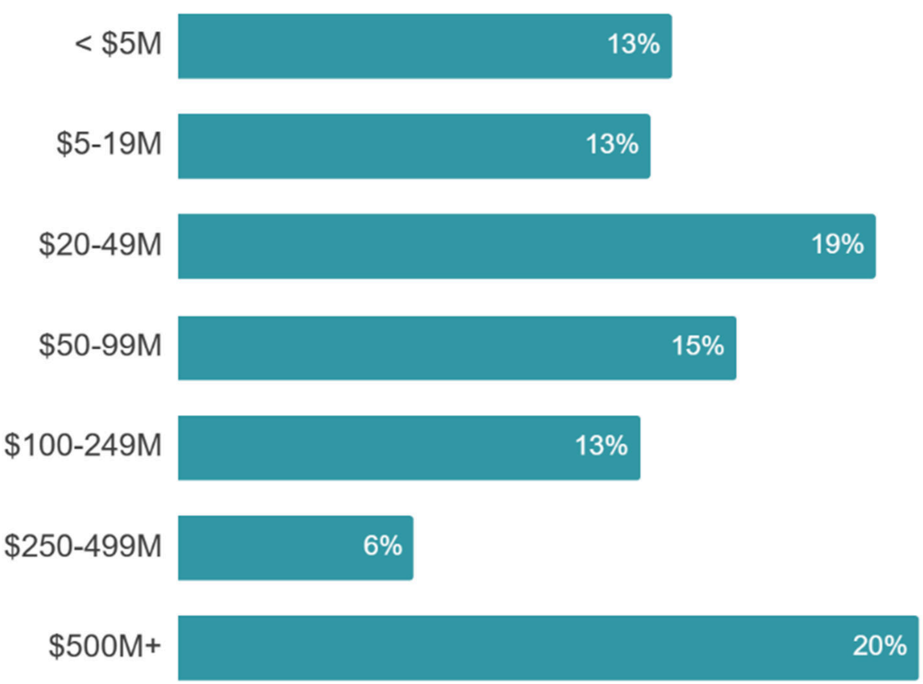
Our own Kyle Smith and Matt Bertuzzi walk through the full report to discuss the findings, changes since the last edition, and long-term trends over the past decade plus.

COMPANIES THAT PARTICIPATED

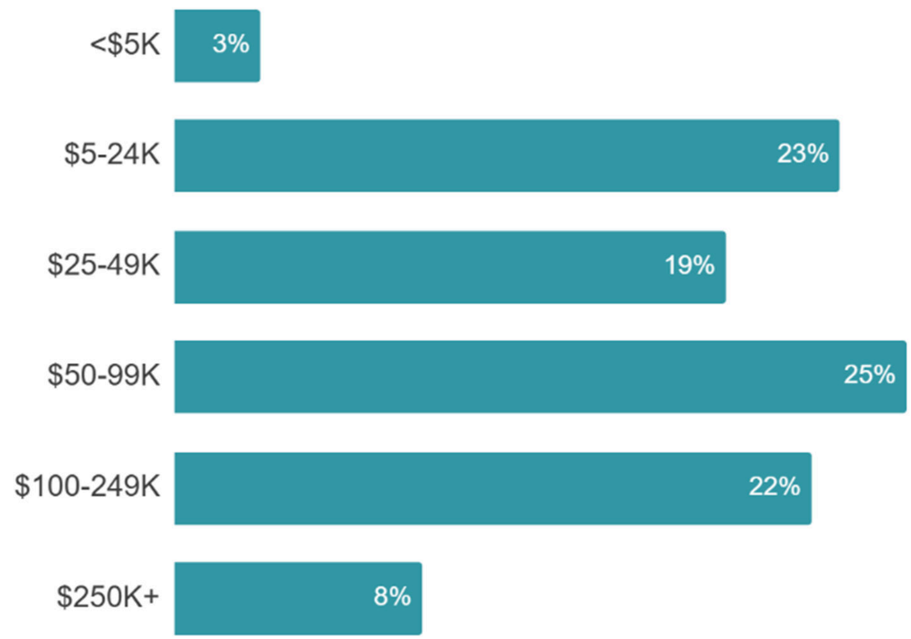
PARTICIPANTS

- 351 executives from a broad range of B2B companies
- 78% North America-based and 83% B2B SaaS
- $47M median revenues
- $50K median average selling price (ASP)

Respondents by revenues

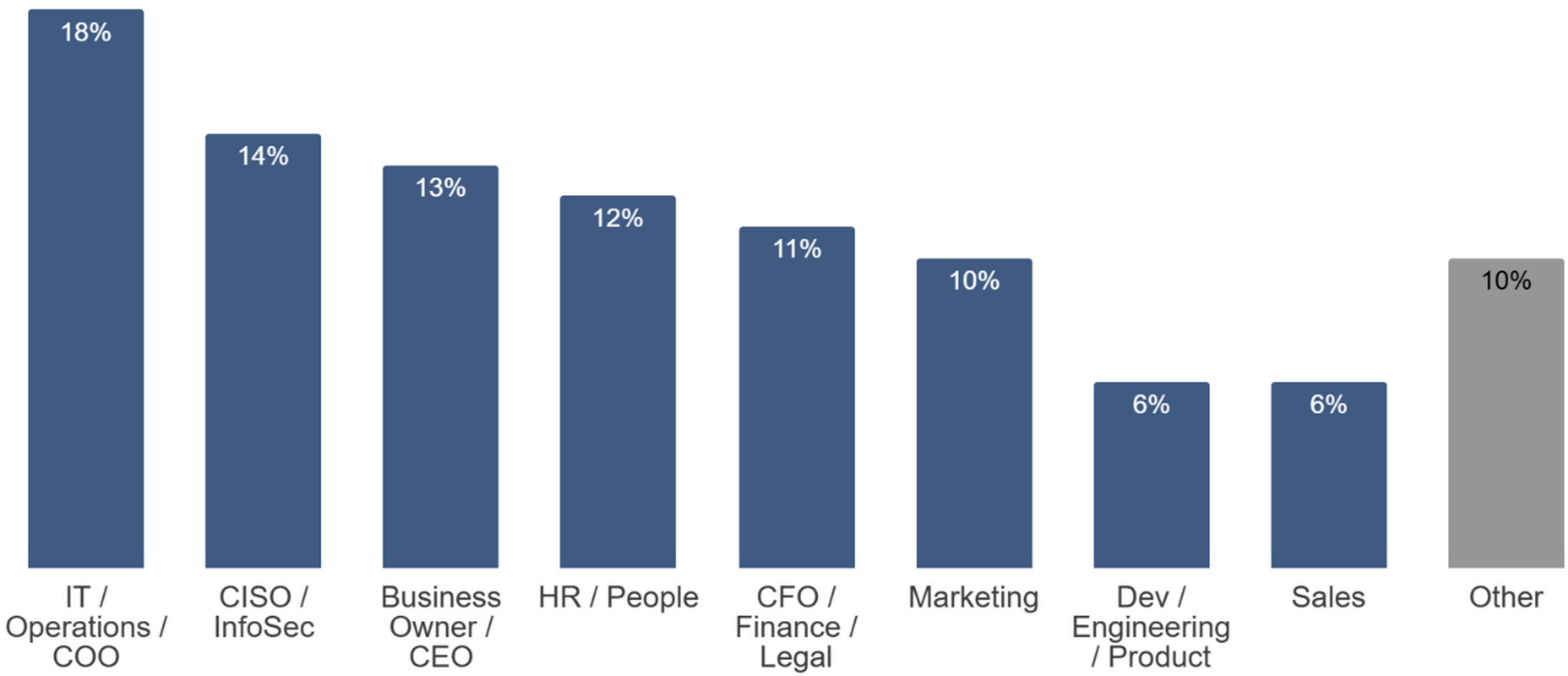


Respondents by ASP



TARGET BUYERS

We asked each respondent which functional area is their primary sales target.



RESPONDENTS BY TARGET BUYER & ASP

	<$5K	$5-25K	$25-50K	$50-100K	$100K+
IT / Operations / COO	0.7%	2%	3%	4%	8%
CISO / InfoSec		1%	2%	5%	6%
Business Owner / CEO	1%	4%	3%	3%	2%
HR / People		3%	3%	4%	2%
CFO / Finance / Legal		3%	3%	2%	3%
Marketing	0.4%	3%	1%	3%	3%
Dev / Engineering / Product	0.4%	1%	1%	2%	2%
Sales		1%	2%	2%	1%
Other	1%	3%	3%	2%	1%

Frequency heatmap

PART 1

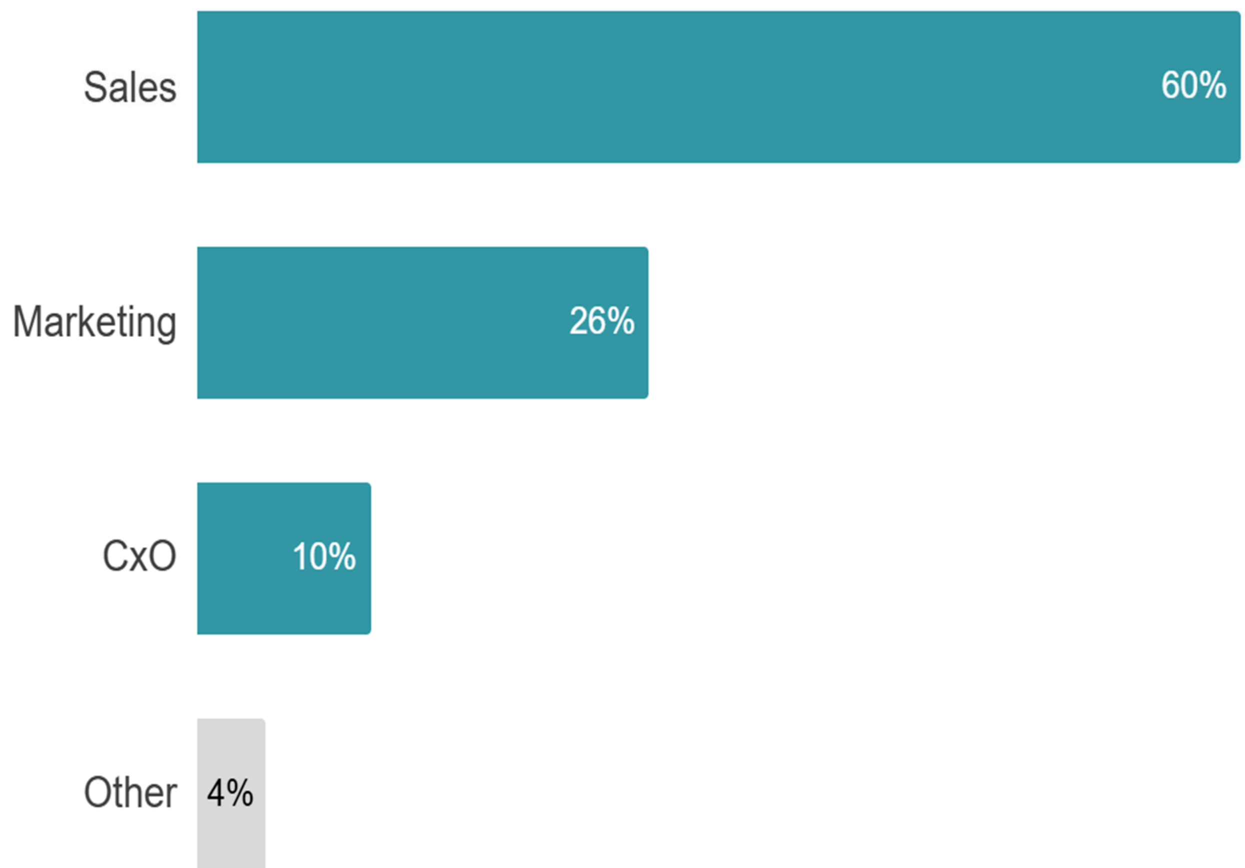
ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

WHERE SDR GROUPS REPORT

Since 2012, we've found the vast majority of SDR teams report to Sales.

This year the trend continues with 60% of groups sitting within the Sales organization.

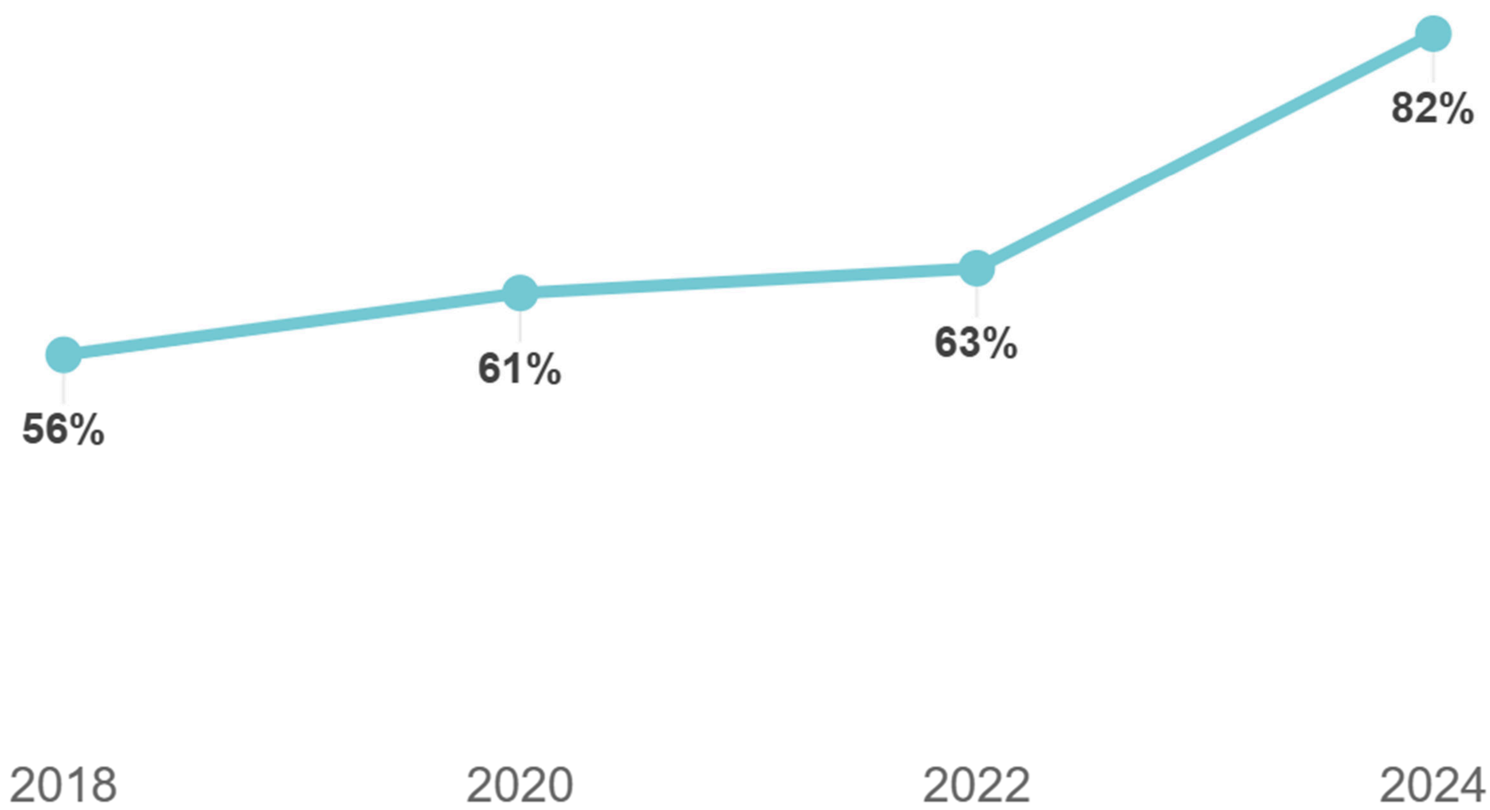
It's worth mentioning that experience and interest trump all other factors in determining the reporting structure.



60% of Sales Development groups report to Sales.

SDRs ALIGN TO AE TERRITORIES

The vast majority (82%) of Sales Development groups align SDRs to AE territories. This persists across revenues and ASP and has been increasing over time. It is worth noting that just 40% of Inbound-only teams align SDRs to AE territories.

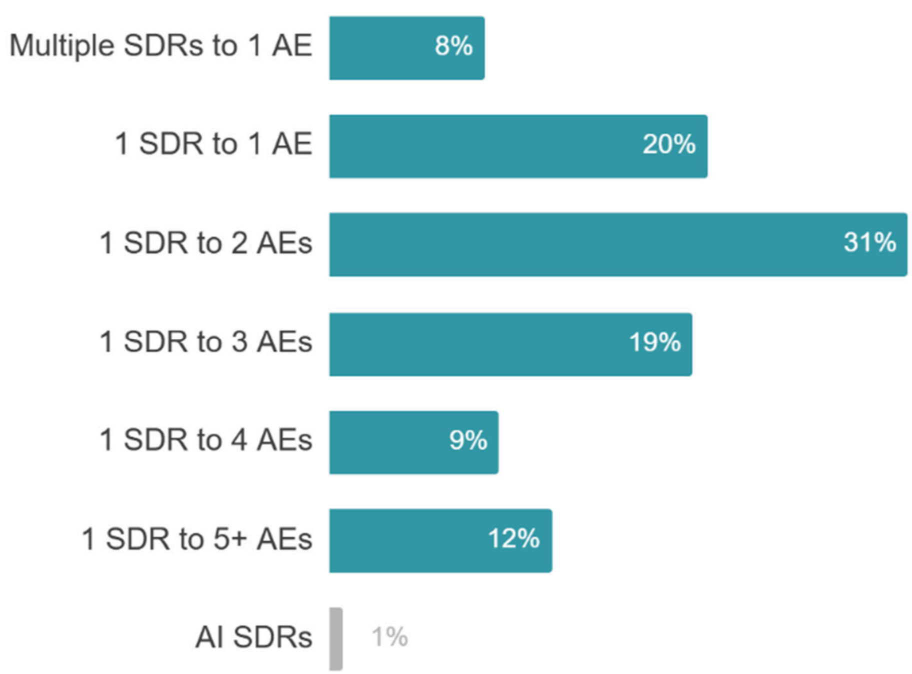


SDR-TO-AE RATIOS

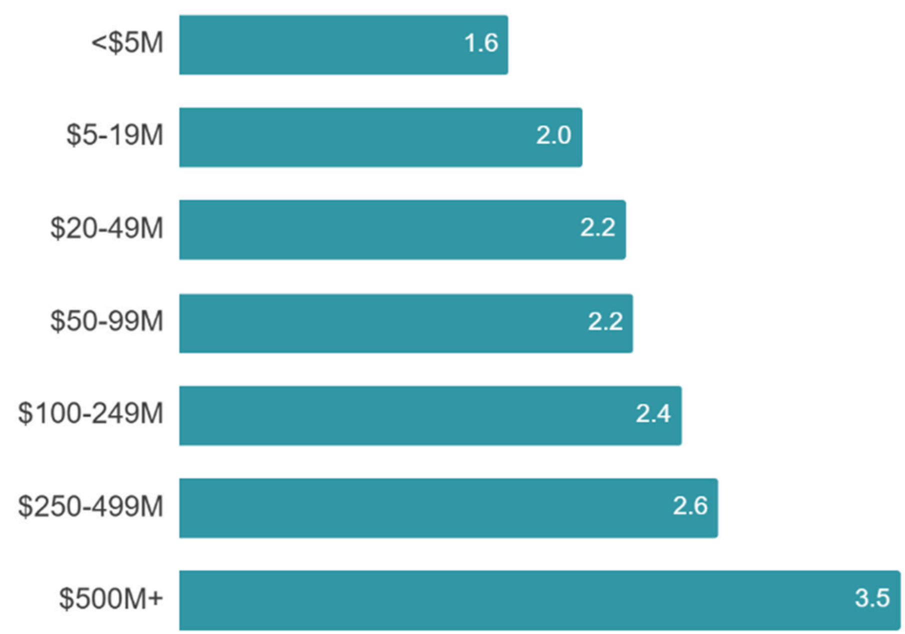
The average ratio is 1 SDR to 2.4 Account Executives. This has been consistent since 2018.

Two things to note: One, smaller companies are much more likely to deploy more SDRs in support of their AEs. And two, this is the first year where “AI SDRs” have been noted in the data.

Distribution of SDR-to-AE ratios

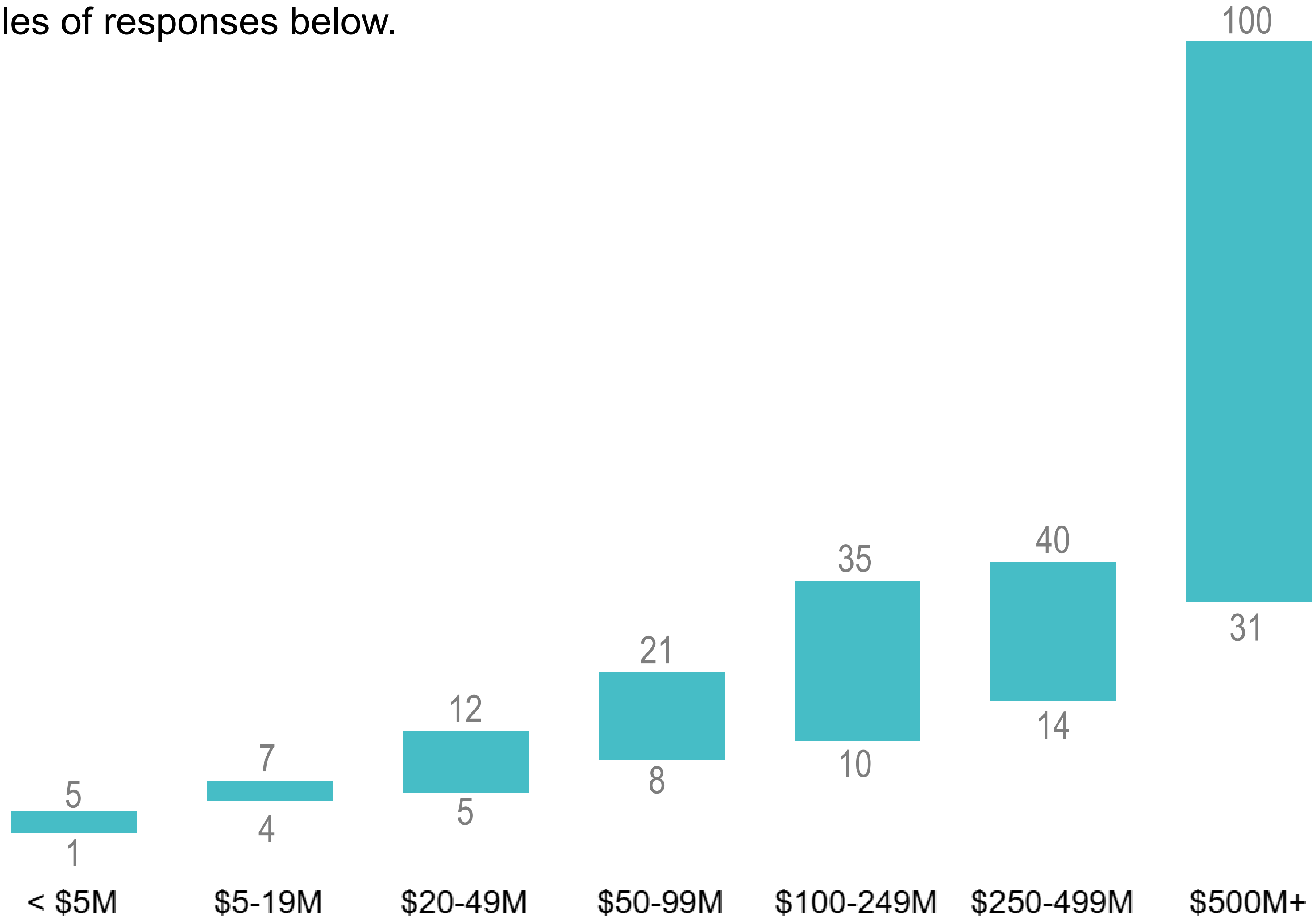


Average AEs supported by 1 SDR *by revenues*



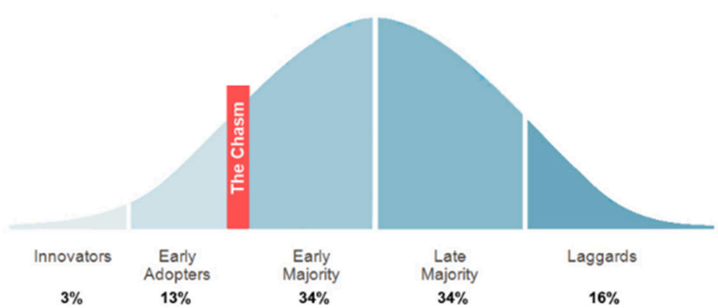
SDR HEADCOUNT BY REVENUES

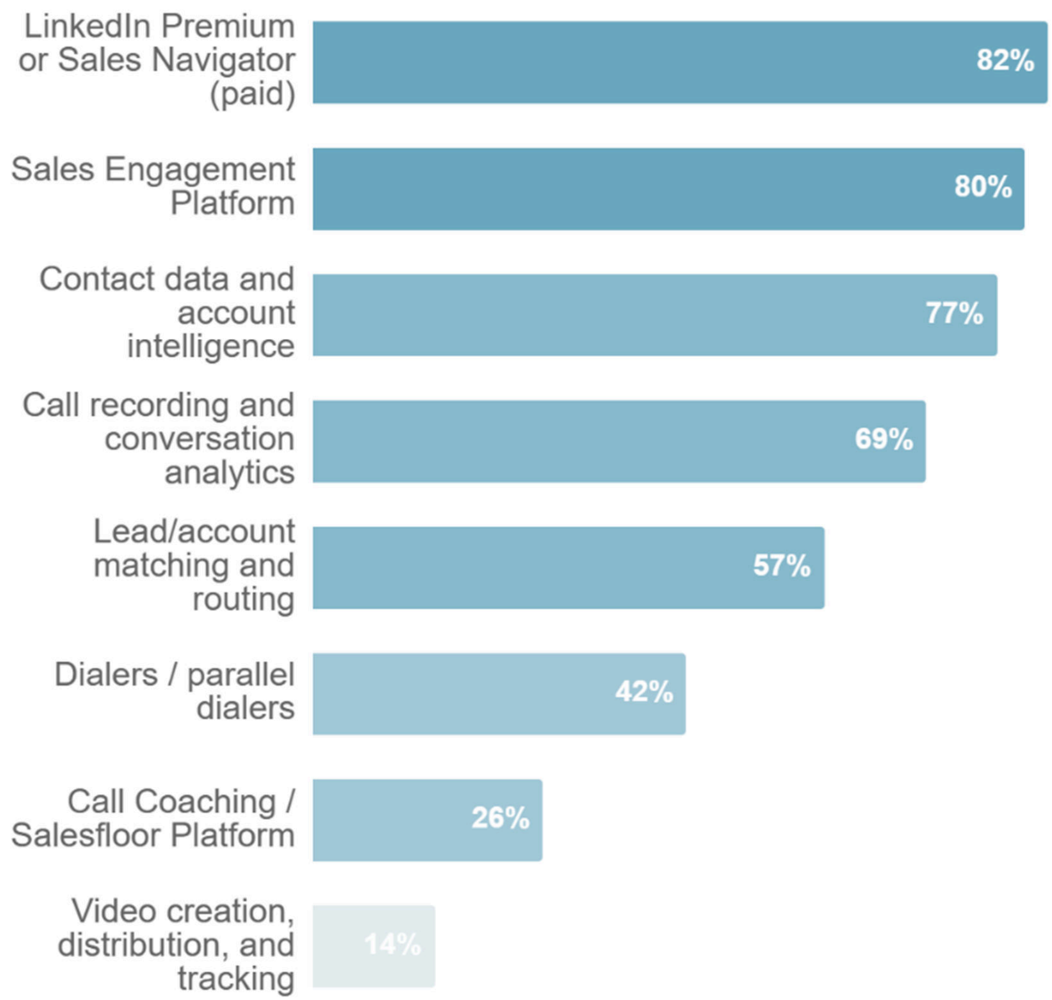
We asked for total, org-wide headcount and have shared the 25th and 75th percentiles of responses below.



ACCELERATION TECHNOLOGIES

Of all the acceleration technologies we covered, the vast majority have crossed the chasm in the adoption lifecycle.





ACCELERATION TECHNOLOGIES BY MOTION

	Inbound	Allbound	Outbound
LinkedIn Premium or Sales Navigator (paid)	56%	88%	81%
Sales engagement platform	72%	84%	77%
Contact data and account intelligence	56%	82%	74%
Call recording and conversation analytics	89%	68%	66%
Lead / account matching and routing	61%	65%	50%
Dialers / parallel dialers	39%	44%	41%
Call coaching / salesfloor platform	33%	24%	28%
Video creation, distribution, and tracking	6%	14%	14%

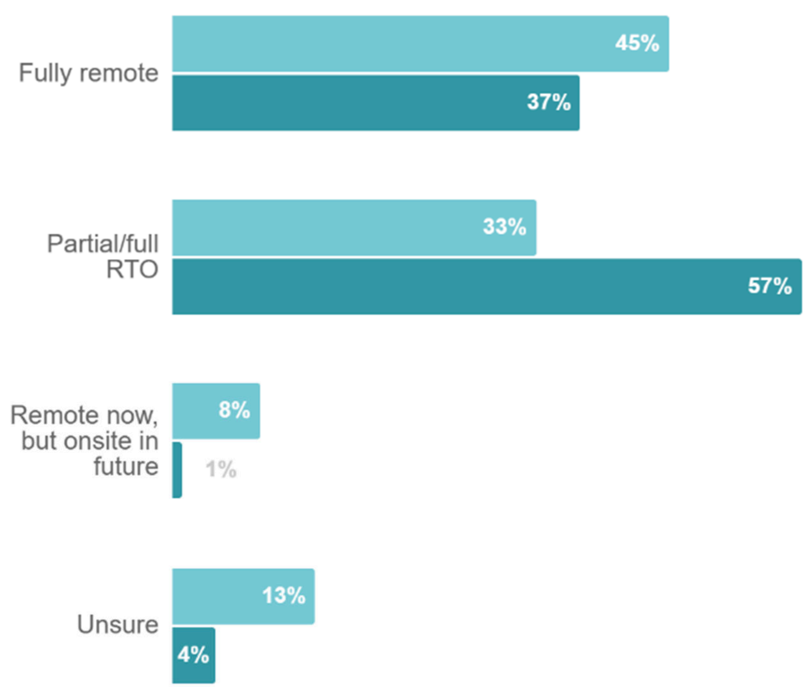
PART 2

HIRING, RAMP, AND ATTRITION

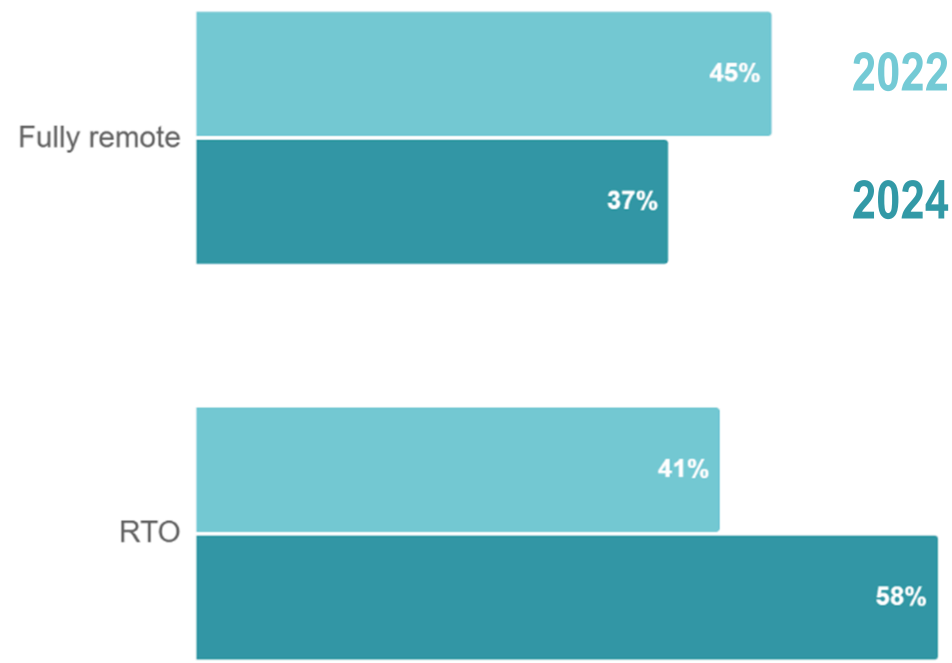
WHERE COMPANIES ARE HIRING NEXT

We asked respondents how they are hiring candidates "for current (or near-term) open positions." Since 2022, there has been movement away from fully remote and toward partial or full RTO.

Distribution of responses



Change *over time*



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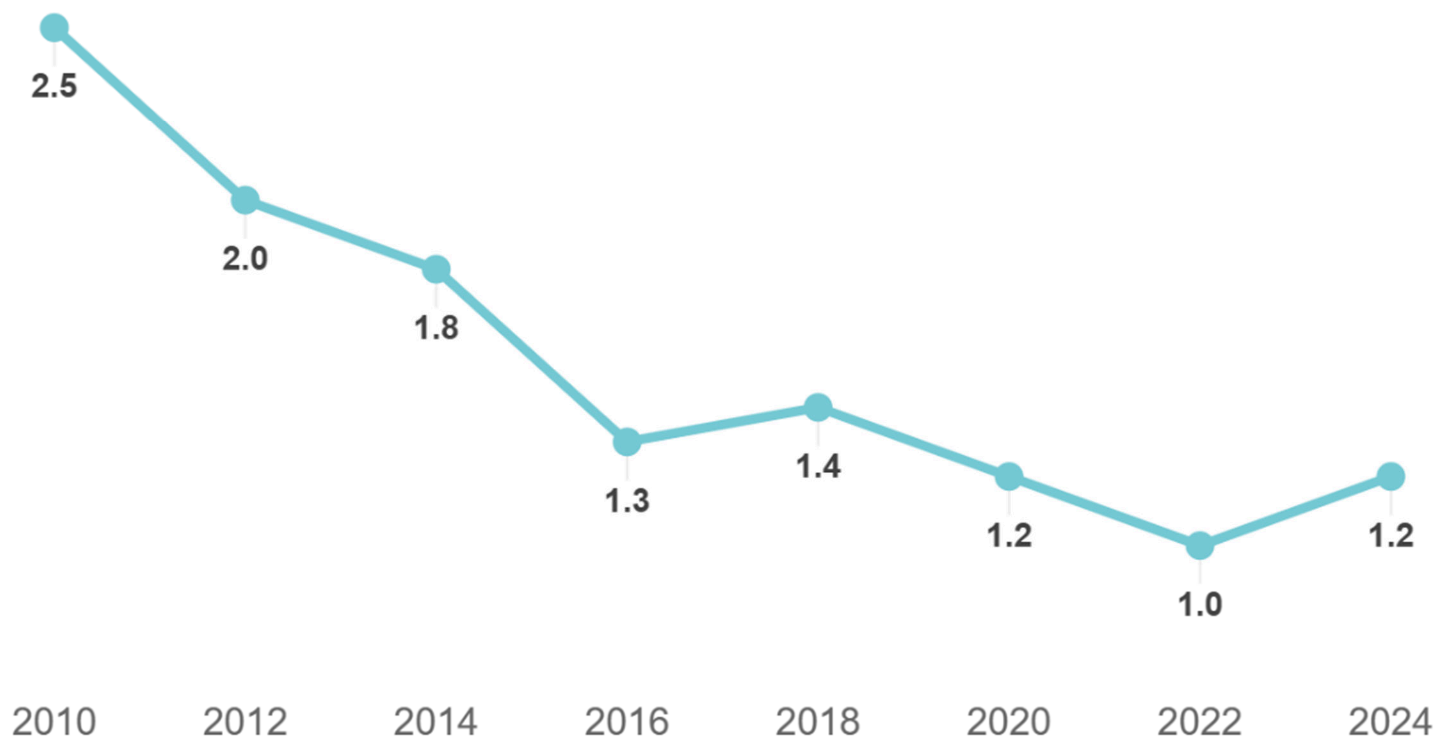
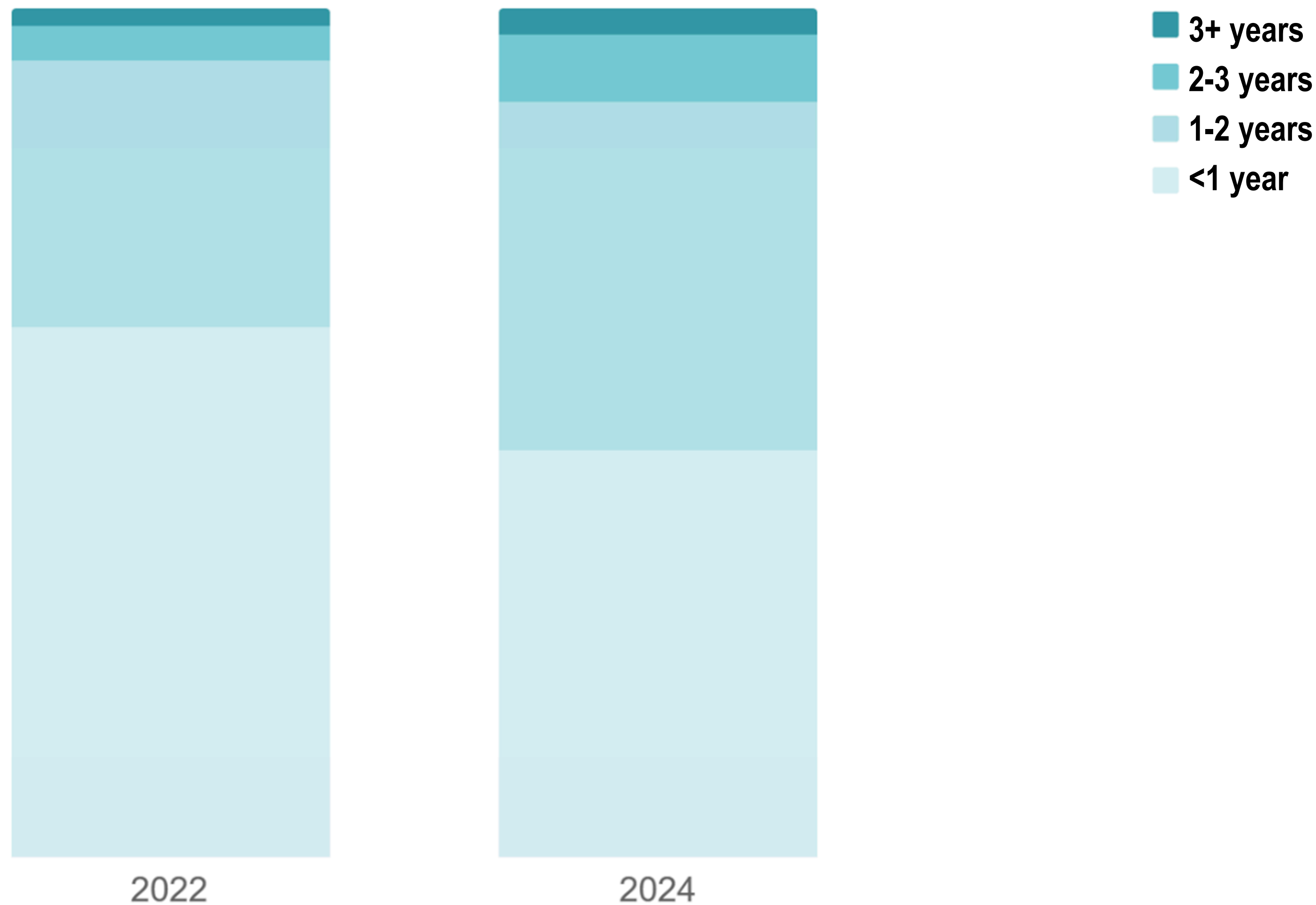
EXPERIENCE REQUIRED AT HIRE

Since 2010, we've seen a 50% fall in required experience. This year, average required experience rebounded slightly to 1.2 years.

Compared to 2022, 23% fewer companies require 0-1 years experience and 32% more require 1-2 years. Much of this reflects a more challenging employment market for SDR talent.



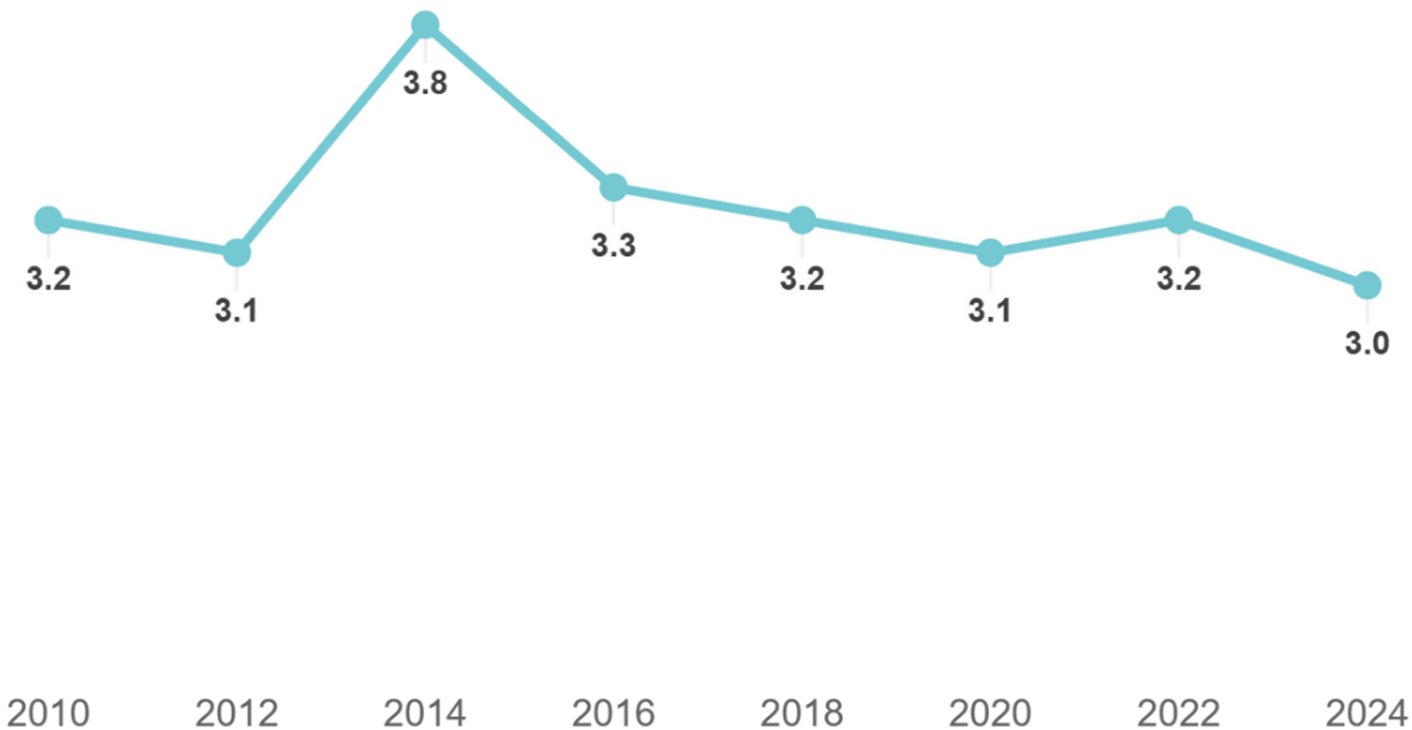
EXPERIENCE REQUIRED AT HIRE 2022 VS. 2024



RAMP TIME

Average ramp time sits at 3.0 months. This is the lowest reading since 2010.

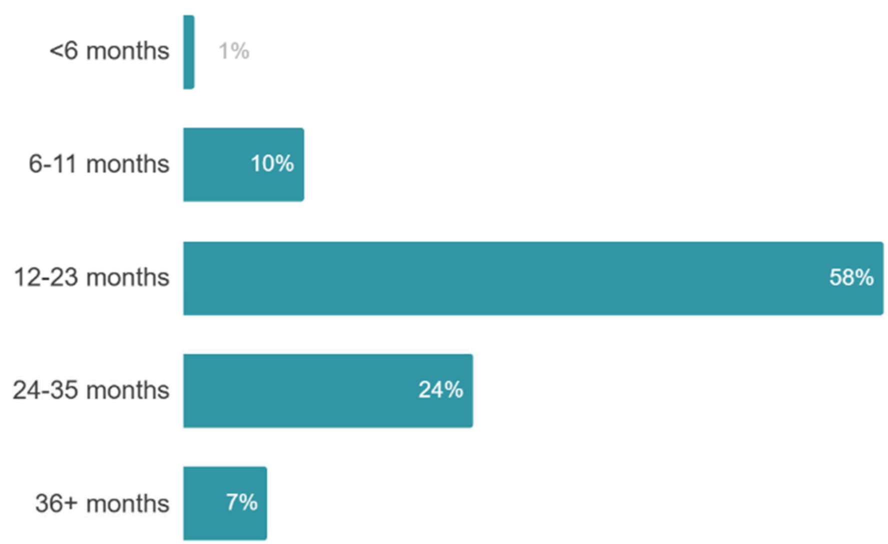
Perhaps we are entering a new era—of AI-powered ramping to productivity. Or perhaps management expectations are tightening, which is bringing ramp-up period into sharp focus.



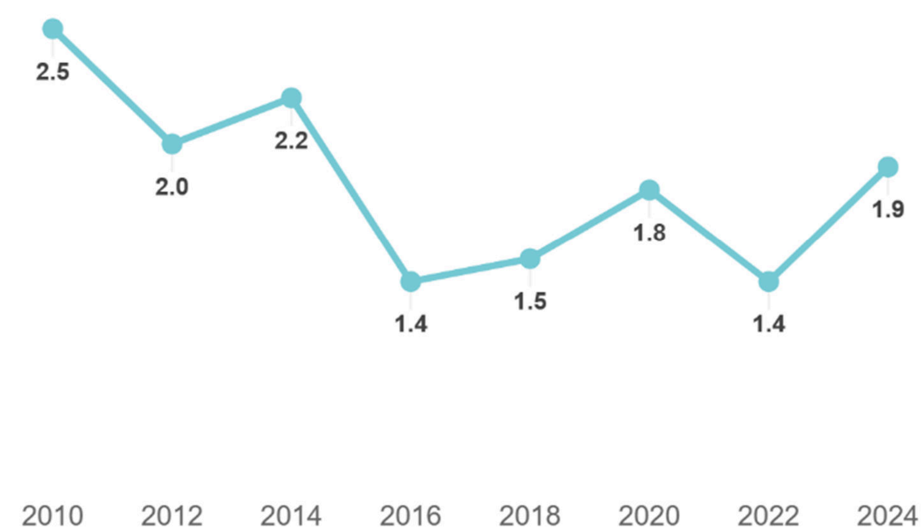
TENURE

Tenure rebounded sharply in 2024—now sitting at 1.9 years. The layoffs of late 2022 and early 2023 (and the highly competitive AE job market of 2024) clearly extended average SDR tenure. At nearly two years, we note average tenure not seen since the early 2010s.

Distribution of average tenure



Average tenure over time

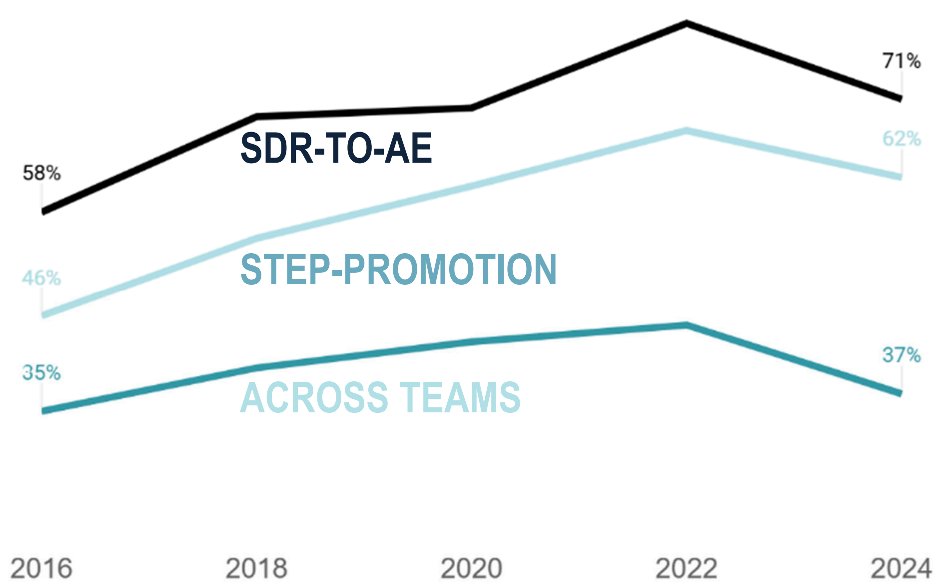


CAREER PATH

The overwhelming majority (97%) of companies offer at least one form of SDR career path. More than half (58%) offer two or more. All three promotion paths are down from the all-time highs of 2022.

SDR-TO-AE	Into an AE role
STEP-PROMOTIONS	Associate, Senior, Principal, etc.
ACROSS TEAMS	Inbound, Outbound, Enterprise, etc.

% offering a given career path *over time*



ATTRITION

The biggest shift from the post-COVID boom (H2-2020 to H2-2021) has been the halving of promotions and the rise and subsequent fall of voluntary quits.

2020	
Involuntary	15%
Voluntary	11%
Promotions	34%

2022	
Involuntary	12%
Voluntary	16%
Promotions	21%

2024	
Involuntary	13%
Voluntary	11%
Promotions	16%

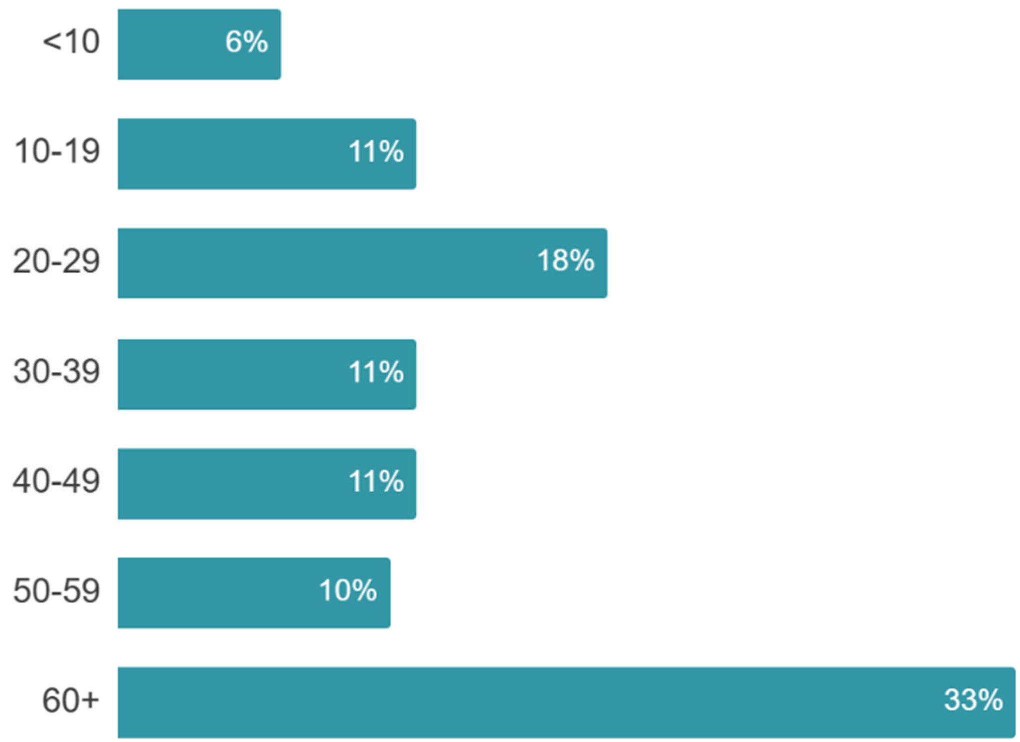
Median annual turnover sits at 40%. The 25th and 75th percentiles are 21% and 57%.

PART 3

METRICS AND QUOTA

DAILY ACTIVITIES

Distribution of average dials per day



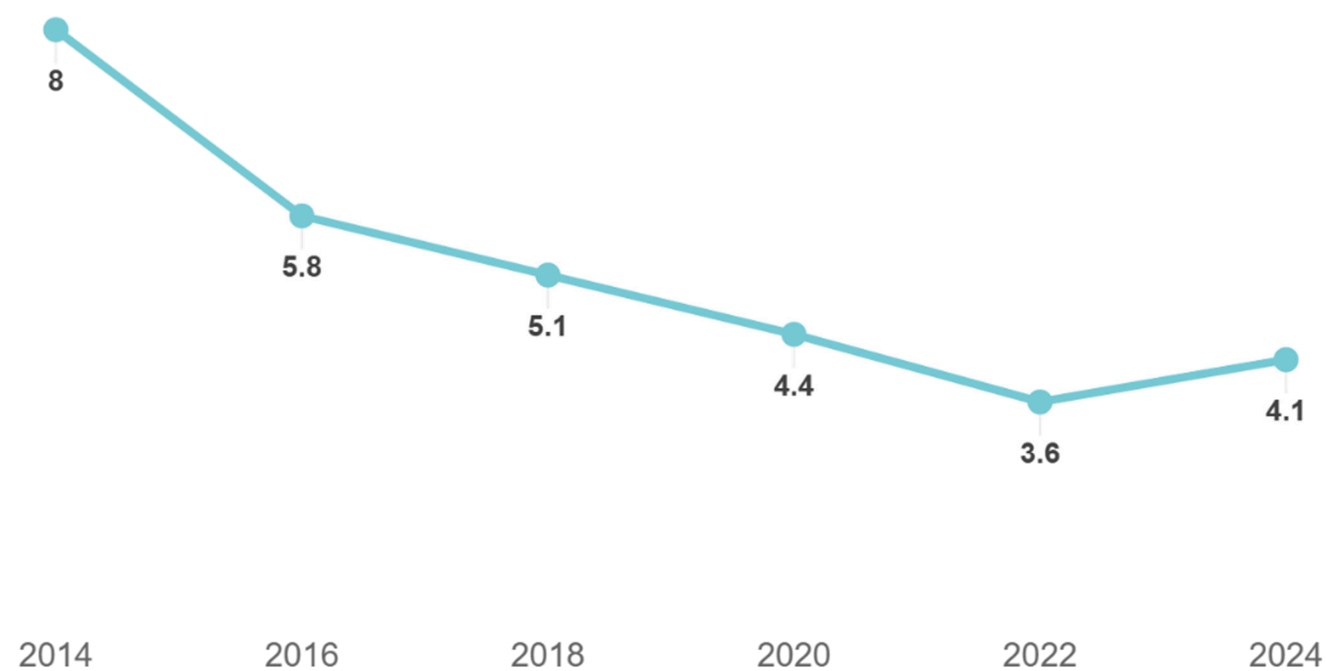
Median activities per day *by type*

TOTAL	**112**
PHONE	44
EMAIL	41
LINKEDIN	19
TEXT/OTHER	8

QCs PER DAY

Another useful metric is the number of *Quality Conversations* (QCs) per rep per day. We define a QC as “a connect or response where at least one piece of qualifying or disqualifying information is learned.”

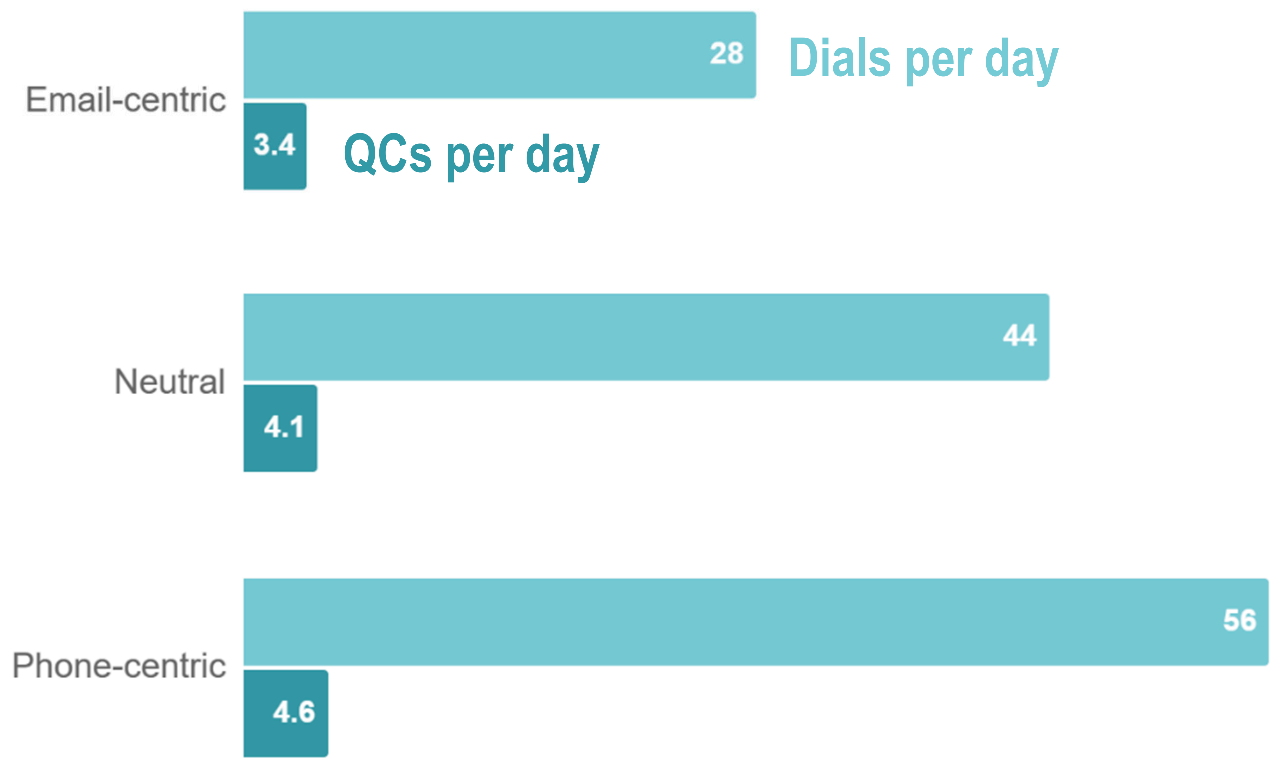
We find an average of 4.1 QCs per rep per day. This is the first rebound in daily QCs since we’ve been tracking this metric.



DAILY QCs BY DOMINANT CHANNEL

We categorized groups as either *Email-centric*, *Phone-centric*, or *Neutral* based on their most dominant outreach channel. Responses indicate a 32% / 41% / 27% divide (email, neutral, phone).

By definition, phone-centric groups average higher dials per day. Interestingly, they also report 1.4X as many QCs.

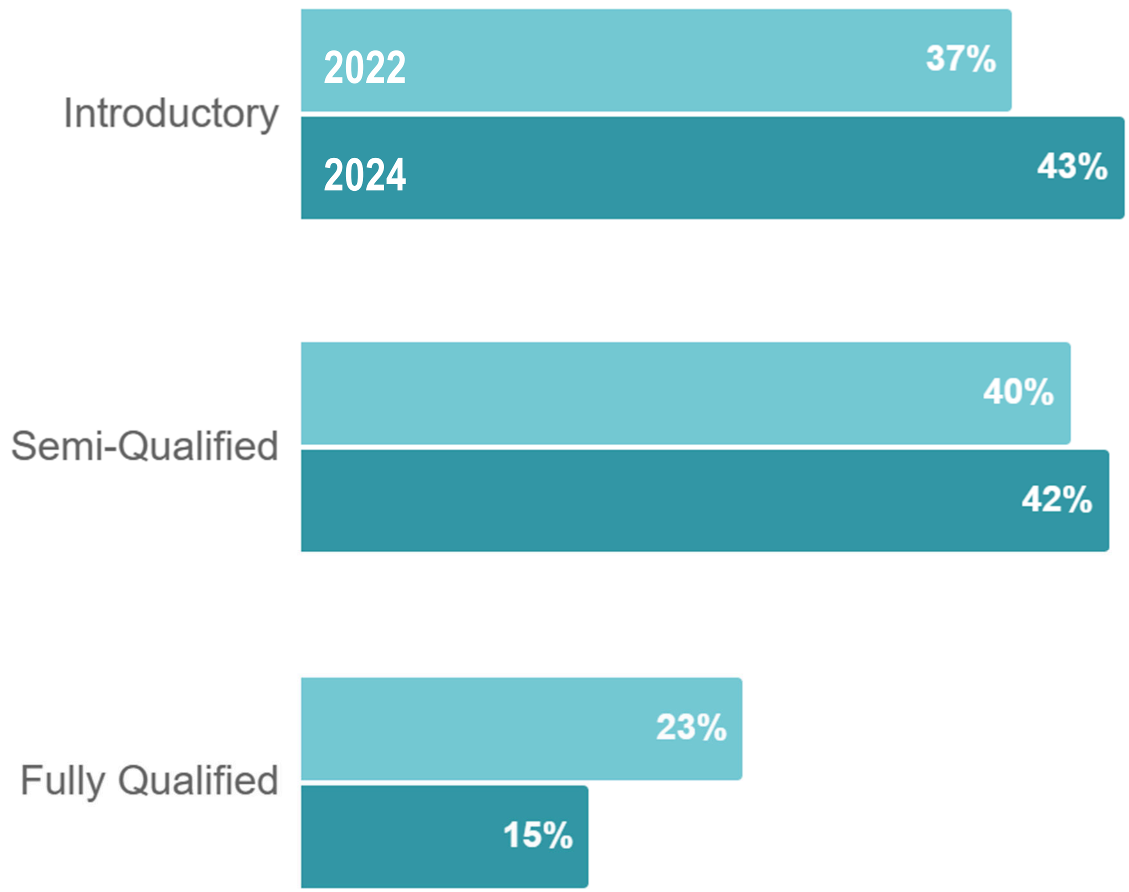


SALES DEVELOPMENT MODEL

Broadly, SDR groups fall into three categories. They include*:*

1. Introductory Meetings
2. Semi-Qualified Opportunities
3. Fully Qualified Opportunities

In our 2022 data, we noted a shift towards more qualified models. This year, companies are moving back down the qualification curve.



QUALIFICATION LEVEL BY MODEL

	Right Profile (firmograhics, tech, etc.)	Pain/need is identified	Person has authority (or access)	Compelling reason (to buy/change)	Money (has it or can get it)	Timeframe is defined
Introductory	68%	42%	25%	7%	1%	0%
Semi-Qual	88%	95%	78%	48%	5%	21%
Fully Qual	85%	98%	98%	93%	68%	65%

- As ASP rises, “pain” and “compelling reason” are more frequently included
- As ASP falls, “authority” and “money” are more frequently included
- Inbound motions are much more likely to include “money” and “timeframe”

MONTHLY QUOTAS

Introductory meetings	
Stage 0 Held	16.0
Stage 1 Converted	8.2

Semi-qualified opptys	
Stage 0 Held	10.4
Stage 1 Converted	6.3

Fully-qualified opptys	
Stage 0 Held	9.0
Stage 1 Converted	6.0

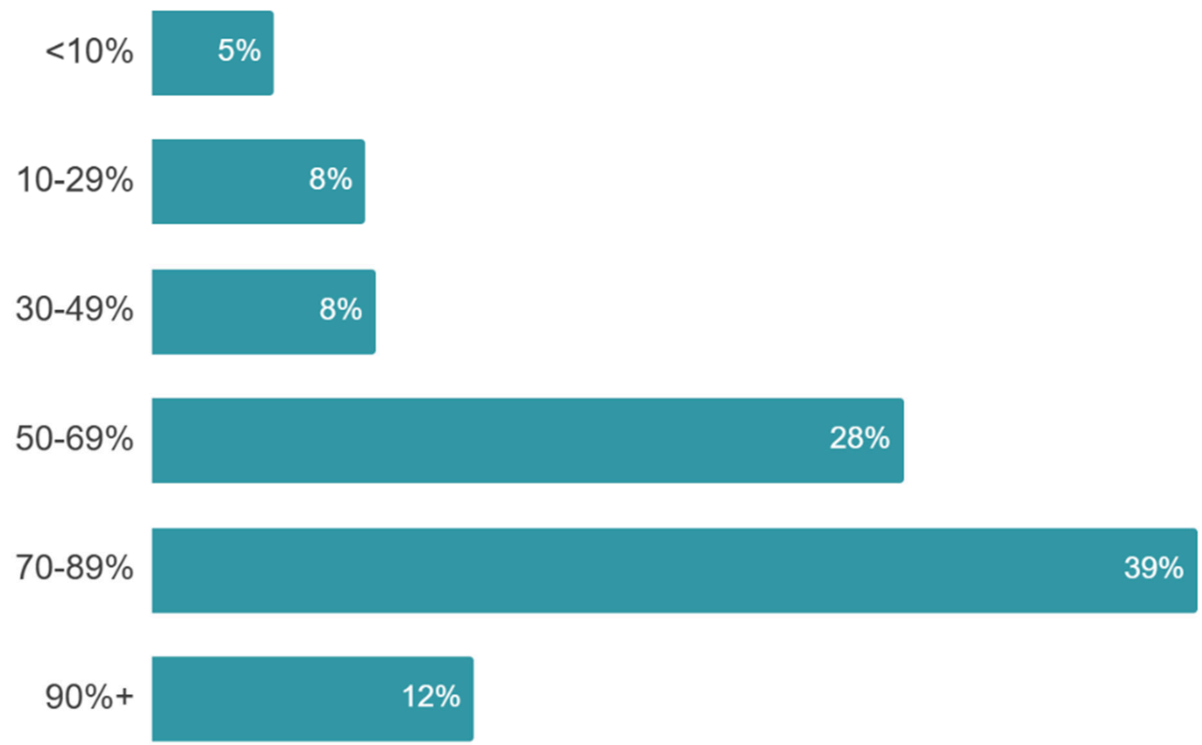
Average quotas remained rock-steady from 2022 to 2024—this is consistent across ASP, motion, and model.

The global median of Stage 0 Passed is 10 and the global median of Stage 1 Converted is 6. Since 2018, Stage 0 and Stage 1 quotas have fallen 40% and 43% respectively.

QUOTA ATTAINMENT

On average, 60% of reps in a given group achieve quota.

This metric has been trending down since 2018 and this year's result is the lowest we have reported.

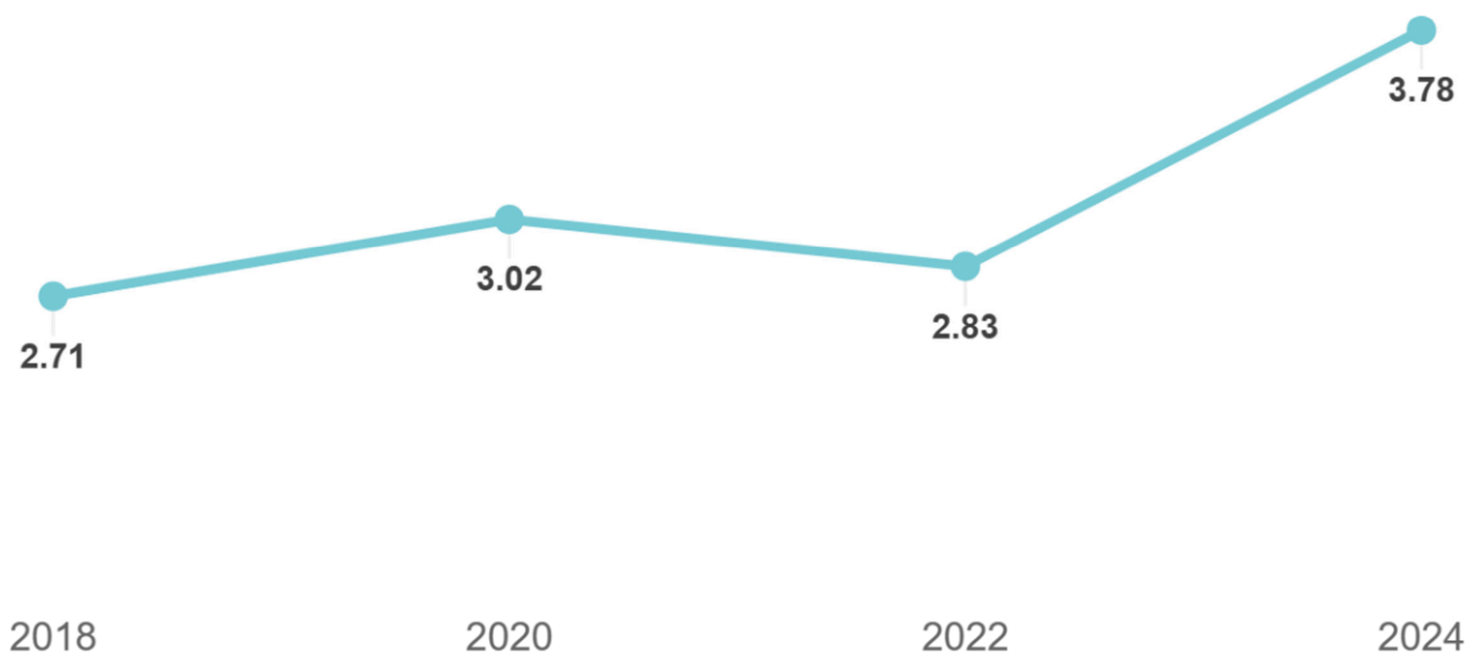


60% of SDRs achieve quota in a given group.

SOURCED PIPELINE PER SDR

The median pipeline generated per SDR rose sharply to $3.78M. (Note this is raw pipeline, not "forecast" nor "closed won.") There is wide variation across companies—but 50% of respondents report between $1.9M and $6.4M generated per SDR annually.

While the number of Stage 1s Opportunities for the median group didn't differ significantly between 2022 and 2024 (8.5 versus 7.9), the ASP certainly did ($27K versus $44K).



PART 4

COMPENSATION

SDR COMPENSATION

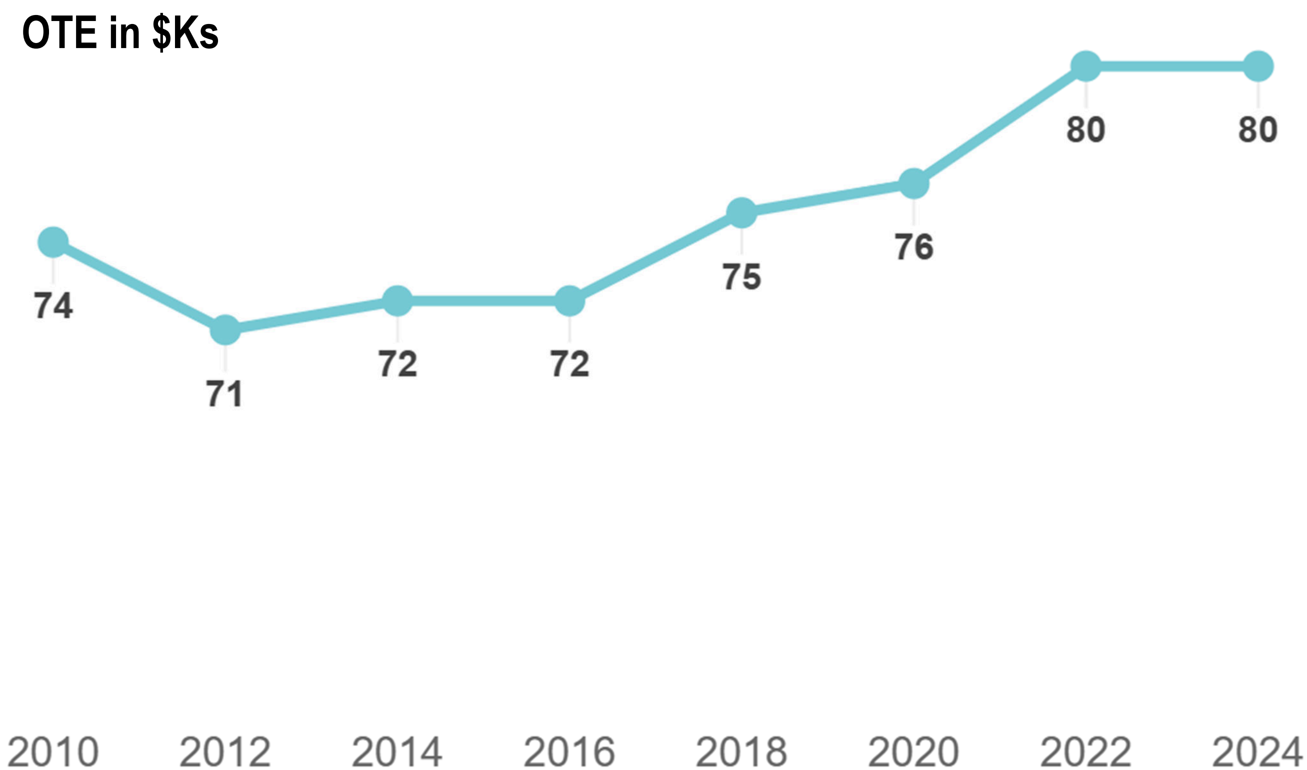
We find median on-target earnings of $80K and a 68:32 (base:variable) split. This remains unchanged since 2022.

ON-TARGET EARNINGS	$80K
BASE	$55K
VARIABLE	$25K

Median SDR on-target earnings have grown at just 0.56% CAGR nominally for more than a decade.

OTE OVER TIME

Over the last 14 years, median SDR OTE has grown 8%—at roughly 0.6% annually. For comparison, US inflation (using CPI) has grown at 43.9% for that same period—or 2.6% annually.



PART 5

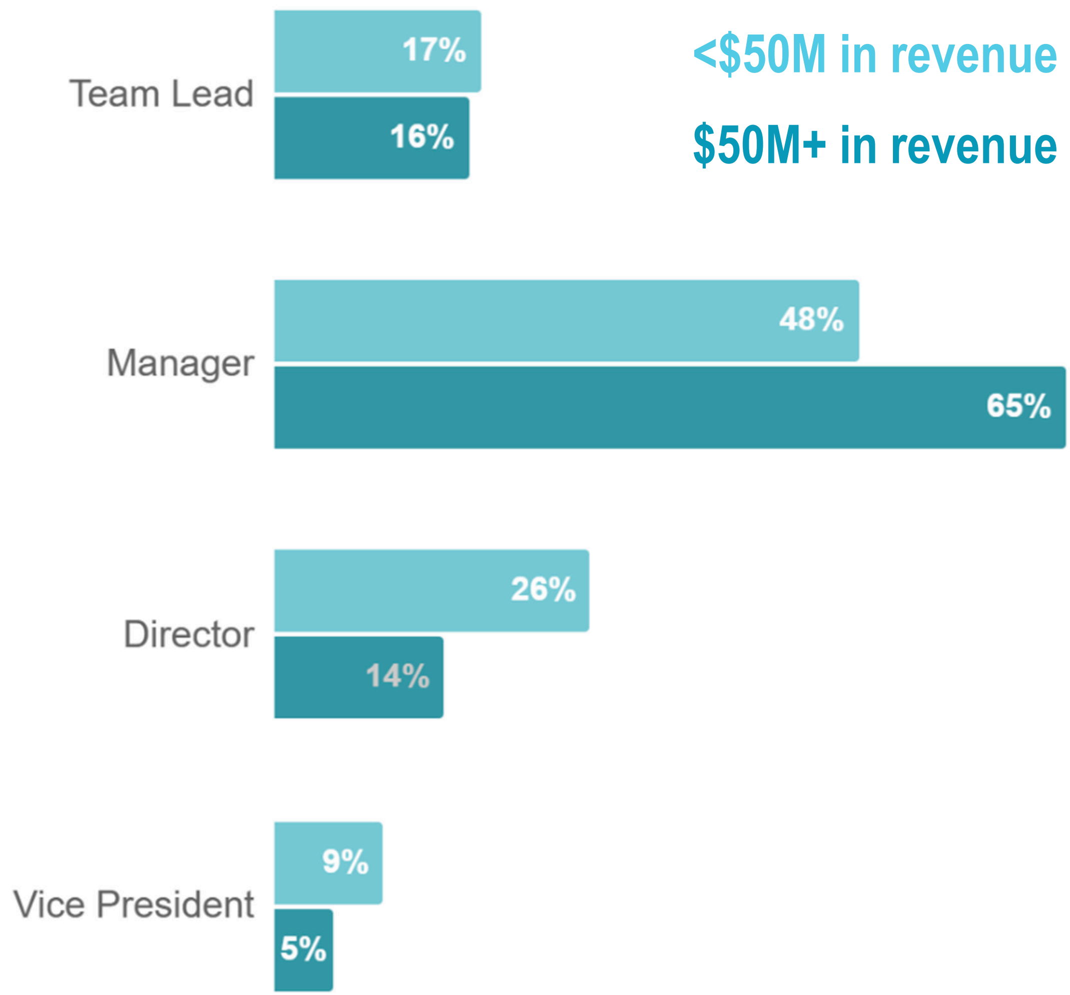
SALES LEADERSHIP

FIRST-LINE LEADERSHIP

We asked respondents, “Which best matches the title of the group's first-line leader?”

For companies at/above $50M in revenue, we find the vast majority of groups are led by *Managers*. *Directors* make up roughly one in seven first-line leaders.

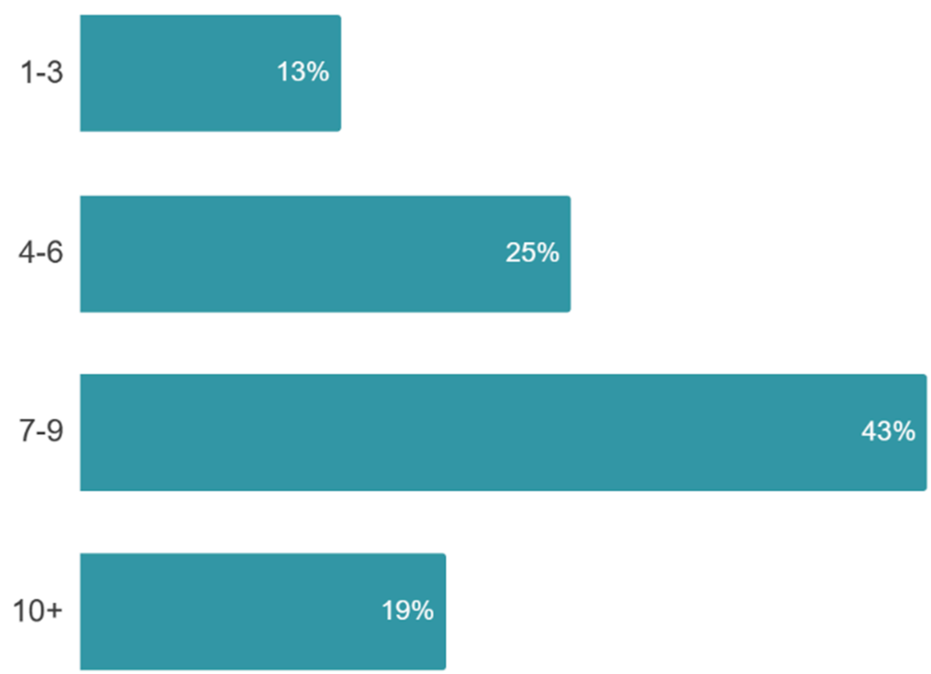
Below $50M in revenues, we find 1.8X as many *Director* or *VP* first-line leaders.



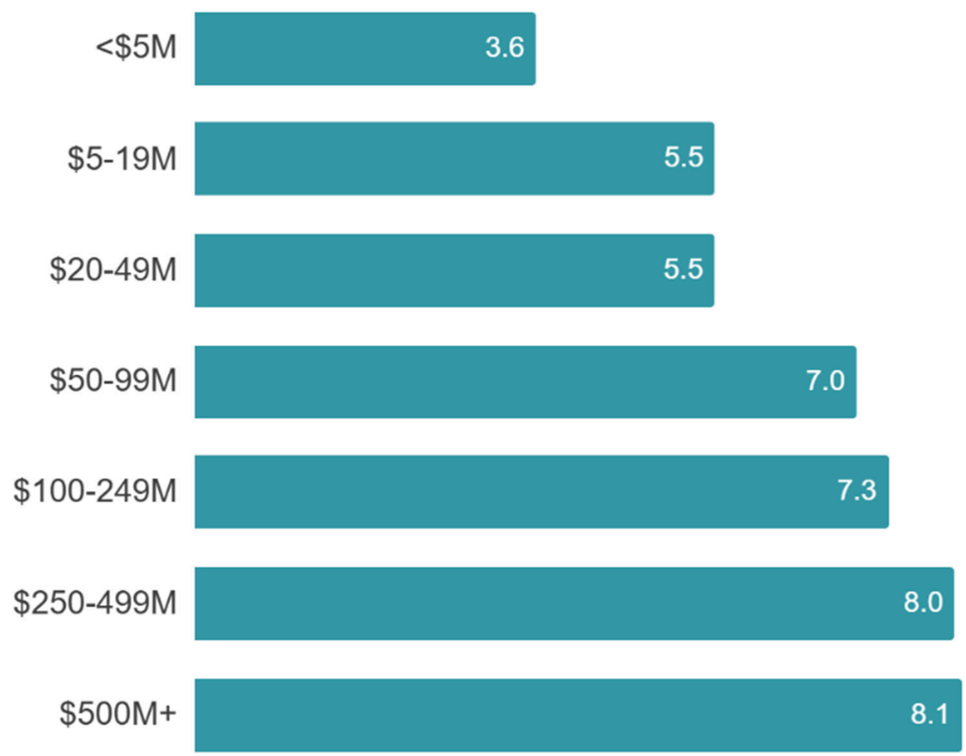
REP-TO-LEADER RATIO

The median number of SDRs reporting to a single first-line leader is 6.4. This is down sharply from our 2021-2023 finding of 8 SDRs per leader.

Distribution of reps per front-line leader



Average # of SDRs per front-line leader by revenue



LEADERSHIP COMPENSATION

Manager total compensation has remained relatively flat in real terms since 2018 (posting a compound annual growth rate of just 0.96%).

This is the first time we've noted negative OTE growth for *Directors* and *Vice Presidents*.

	2018	2020	2022	2024
MANAGER	$127K	$128K	$137K	$146K
DIRECTOR	$172K	$177K	$193K	$189K
VICE PRESIDENT	$215K	$226K	$243K	$240K

LEADERSHIP COMPENSATION BY ASP

Controlling for company revenues and other factors, front-line leaders' on-target earnings rise as ASP increases.

	$5-25K	$25-50K	$50-100K	$100-250K	$250K+
MANAGER	$123K	$138K	$150K	$145K	$170K
DIRECTOR	$135K	$183K	$188K	$210K	$221K
VICE PRESIDENT	$168K	[1]	$233K	$300K	[1]

[1] Too few rows to provide meaningful data

WHAT WE DO

Strategy & Benchmarking

Modern Sales Playbooks

Tailored Coaching & Training

Fractional Leadership

NIMBLE, NOT FORMULAIC.
REPEATABLE, NOT ASPIRATIONAL.
PRACTICAL, NOT THEORETICAL.

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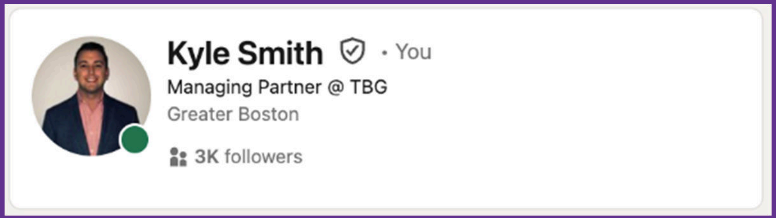
THANK YOU!

Questions or comments? Email us COMMUNITY@BRIDGEGROUPINC.COM

Or connect on LinkedIn:



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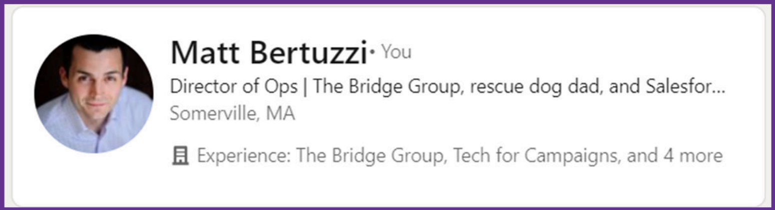

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